

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Pronunciation Spot: A small misunderstanding.



Learning Outcome

Understand actions, events, and experiences in present, past or future and in spoken or written texts and in work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- When was the last time you stayed in a hotel?
- Have you ever been involved in a misunderstanding? Explain.

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about the present result of events that started in the past in work and job issues.
- I can claim, mention, request, or point out an idea, thing, or issue in the workplace.
- I can distinguish between spelling and pronunciation of words.





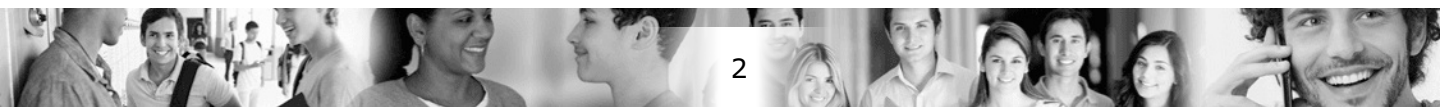
Let's Explore!

I wanted a warm shower, not **clam chowder***!

* "Clam chowder" is a seafood soup common in the Northeastern USA.

Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Receptionist** : Welcome! Are you here to check in?
Adam : Yes. We reserved two rooms. My secretary has also sent a few special requests by e-mail.
Receptionist : Let me see. There's no reservation under either name.
Adam : Impossible. This has been in the works for months. Could you check under BFP, please?
Receptionist : Ahh, there we go. You have one room booked.
Adam : There must have been some mistake. We definitely booked two rooms. I haven't shared a room since I was in college.
Receptionist : It says here that a request was made. It says, "we'd like to share."
Adam : Chair, not share. It was requested that an office chair be provided, because we are going to be working from the room.
Receptionist : Oh, I see, so you're sure you don't want to share? It might strengthen your working relationship.
Adam : Yes, I'm absolutely sure we don't want to share.
Receptionist : Now, about the clam chowder that was mentioned in your email, we normally don't serve ...
Adam : It says that I wanted a warm shower, not clam chowder! Why in the world would I want clam chowder?
Receptionist : We couldn't figure it out either. And then it was pointed out that you are from Boston. We assumed you must have wanted a little taste of home.
Adam : Well, you assumed wrong, I'm afraid. It must have been an autocorrect mistake. My secretary sent the e-mail from her cellphone.
Receptionist : Right. Now, I notice that a tree tower was mentioned. We have a strict "no tree tower" policy.
Adam : Are you kidding me? I said I want three towels, not a tree tower. What is a tree tower, anyway?
Receptionist : One of our bellhops claimed that it's a sort of tree house, where people from Boston go to eat clam chowder.
Adam : Ummm, no.
Receptionist : Okay, now that we've got that straightened out, here's your key. The thrash band is already in the room, rehearsing.
Adam : A thrash band? Playing thrash metal? In my room! My god, I'm afraid to ask.
Receptionist : It's written here, sir. "One thrash band beside the desk, please."
Adam : A trash bin, for garbage!
Receptionist : We thought it was a Boston thing.
Adam : Of course you did. Well, thanks anyway.
Receptionist : Did you say tanks? I'm afraid we don't allow those, either.





Let's Practice!

What is a tree tower, anyway?

Instructions: Circle the correct word according to the dialogue. Practice the dialogue with a partner and read it aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

- Adam:** My secretary has also sent a few special requests by e-mail.
Receptionist: It says, "We'd like to (*share/ chair*).
Adam: (*Share/ Chair*), not share.
Receptionist: We have a strict "no (*three/ tree*) tower" policy.
Adam: I said I want (*three/ tree*) towels , not a (*three/ tree*) tower.
Receptionist: Okay, now that we've got that straightened out, here's your key. It's written here, sir. "One (*trash/ thrash*) band beside the desk, please."
Adam: A (*trash/ thrash*) bin, for garbage! Well, (*tanks/ thanks*) anyway.
Receptionist: Did you say (*tanks/ thanks*)? I'm afraid we don't allow those, either.



Let's Practice!

Tell me about your past!

Instructions: Organize the mystery sentences. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. requests / special / e-mail / also / a / sent / . / My / secretary / has / few / by

2. in / works / months / This / for / . / been / the / has

3. must / There / mistake / . / some / have / been

4. shared / a / I / I / . / haven't / college / in / since / room / was

5. must / . / assumed / of / you / taste / home / wanted / a / little / We / have

6. mistake / It / must / . / autocorrect / been / an / have





Extension Activity

Make a list of minimal pairs.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Go online and find ten words that start with "S" or "T".
- Find ten more words that have the same pronunciation, but that begin with "SH" or "TH". (i.e. tanks, thanks).
- Make ten sentences which include one example of each minimal pair.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I research words that sound alike.

☐ ☐

I create sentences with words that sound alike.

☐ ☐

I read my sentences with a partner.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- to check in** (verb): to report your arrival at a hotel or airport
e.g. Are you here to check in?
- to book** (verb): to reserve
e.g. We definitely booked two rooms.
- bellhop** (noun): a person at a hotel who carries bags for guests
e.g. One of our bellhops claimed that it's a sort of tree house.
- strict** (adjective): demanding that rules be obeyed
e.g. We have a strict "no tree tower" policy.
- to straighten out** (verb): to clear up or clarify a misunderstanding
e.g. Now that we've got that straightened out, here's your key.
- to reserve** (verb): to claim something for use in the future
e.g. We reserved two rooms.
- to be in the works** (expression): to be planned
e.g. This has been in the works for months.





Learning Points

Minimal Pairs and Consonant Clusters

Consonant clusters are a combination of consonant sounds. These can be difficult to pronounce for some English language learners.

Minimal Pairs are two words that sound similar, except for one sound.

Some examples of consonant clusters are:

sp - **s**pecial
thr - **th**ree
tr - **tr**ash
str - **str**aight

To avoid being misunderstood, you should:

- avoid changing a consonant in a cluster to a different consonant (present/pleasant)
- avoid leaving out one of the consonant sounds (poblem/problem)
- avoid adding an extra vowel between consonants (tewin/twin)
- avoid adding an extra vowel at the beginning of a word (estop/stop)

Practicing minimal pairs is a good way to avoid these problems.

Try saying these words from the dialogue. Focus on the slight difference between them:

thanks tanks
three tree
thrash trash
share chair

Now, read these sentences from the dialogue out loud.

Examples:

- *Okay, now that we've got that **straightened** out, here's your key.*
- *A **trash** bin, for garbage!*
- *It might **strengthen** your working relationship.*

